

FREE DOWNLOAD · NO CODE REQUIRED

NO CODE REQUIRED

The \$0 AI Starter Kit

5 free tools. 1 working automation by tonight.

Most guides give you information. This one gives you output — pick one workflow, follow the steps, and you're done.

\$0

MONTHLY COST

90

MIN TO FIRST AUTOMATION

0

LINES OF CODE

Real tools. Tested workflows. No jargon.

www.nocoderequired.net

Start here — pick one workflow

Every AI article starts with "the landscape is changing" and ends with a course pitch. This isn't that. These are tools I actually use and automations I actually built. If you can copy-paste a URL, you can finish this kit.

CHOOSE YOUR PATH (60 SECONDS)

Don't build all three. Pick the one that solves your most annoying daily task. Build it today. Come back for the rest.

★ **RECOMMENDED — START HERE**

Path A: Client Follow-Up Sequence

You lose leads because follow-up never feels urgent. By tonight, every new inquiry gets 3 automatic follow-ups. ~90 min setup · Make.com

Path B: Social Media Backup

If Instagram suspends your account tomorrow, you lose every caption and link. Auto-log every post to a spreadsheet. ~15 min · Zapier

Path C: New Subscriber Alert

Get a ping the second someone joins your email list. Makes growth feel real. ~10 min · Make.com

One rule: Build Path A first unless you have zero clients and zero forms. It's the highest-ROI workflow for solo business owners — and the full walkthrough with exact email copy is on the blog.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- **5 free tools** — what each one does, free tier limits, when to use it
- **Path A step-by-step** — webhook → delays → 3 emails (pages 4–6)
- **Paths B & C** — quick-setup summaries (page 7)
- **Next steps** — where to go after your first win (page 8)

5 free tools (and what I use each one for)

Every tool here has a free tier that's genuinely useful — not a 14-day trial that locks you out after you've set everything up.

ChatGPT

chatgpt.com

Your AI assistant for emails, brainstorming, summarizing docs, drafting social posts. Free tier (GPT-4o-mini) handles 90% of everyday tasks.

I use it for: First drafts, rewriting follow-up emails, brainstorming blog titles.

Make.com

make.com

Visual automation builder — drag boxes, connect lines, no code. Multi-step workflows with delays and conditions.

Free tier: 1,000 operations/month · **Best for:** Follow-up sequences, complex workflows (Path A & C).

Zapier

zapier.com

Connects apps with simple "when X, do Y" rules. Gentler learning curve than Make, fewer multi-step options.

Free tier: 100 tasks/month · **Best for:** Simple 2-step automations (Path B).

Notion

notion.so

Notes, databases, project tracking, content calendars — all in one. Free for personal use.

I use it for: Client tracking, blog calendar, automation notes.

Canva

canva.com

Design social posts, thumbnails, PDFs without being a designer. 250,000+ free templates.

I use it for: Blog covers, reel thumbnails, lead magnets like this one.

Not sure which tool fits your stack? Use the free AI Tool Advisor at www.nocoderequired.net/ai-tool-advisor.html — answer 3 questions, get one specific recommendation.

Path A: Client Follow-Up Sequence

~90 min setup

Make.com

80% of sales need at least 5 follow-ups — but most solo owners give up after one. This workflow sends 3 automatic follow-ups to every new lead. You write the emails once. The system runs forever.

THE LOGIC

Trigger: Someone fills out your contact form

Then: Wait 24h → Email 1 → Wait 3 days → Email 2 → Wait 4 days → Email 3 (final)

STEPS 1-4: SET UP THE TRIGGER

- 1 Sign up at **make.com** (free). Click "**Create a new scenario.**"
- 2 Add module: **Webhooks** → **Custom webhook**. Make gives you a unique URL.
- 3 Paste the webhook URL into your contact form (Typeform, Tally, Google Forms, or any form with webhook support).
- 4 Submit a **test entry** with your own email so Make detects the data fields (name, email, etc.).
- 5 Add **Flow Control** → **Sleep** → **24 hours**. Gives them time to reply naturally first.
- 6 Add **Email module** (Gmail, Outlook, or SMTP). Connect your sending account.
- 7 Map the recipient field to the email from your webhook data. Map the name field for personalization.

EMAIL 1 — DAY 1 (AFTER 24H WAIT)

SUBJECT LINE

Following up on your inquiry

BODY

Hey [name],

Just wanted to make sure my last message didn't get buried. Happy to answer any questions — just hit reply.

[your name]

Path A: Emails 2 & 3 + go live

EMAIL 2 — DAY 4 (3 DAYS AFTER EMAIL 1)

Add another **Sleep (3 days)** module, then another **Email** module:

SUBJECT LINE

Quick thought on [their problem]

BODY

Hey [name],

I was thinking about [specific thing they mentioned]. Here's a quick tip: [one useful thing].

If you want to chat more, I'm around.

[your name]

EMAIL 3 — FINAL CHECK-IN (4 DAYS AFTER EMAIL 2)

Add **Sleep (4 days)**, then final **Email**:

SUBJECT LINE

Last note from me

BODY

Hey [name],

I don't want to clog your inbox, so this is my last follow-up. If you'd like to pick things up later, just reply whenever works. No pressure.

[your name]

TEST BEFORE YOU GO LIVE

- 1 Set all Sleep timers to **1 minute** for testing.
- 2 Submit your own email through the form. Confirm all 3 emails arrive with correct names.
- 3 Reset Sleep timers to real delays: **24 hours, 3 days, 4 days**.
- 4 Turn the scenario **ON**. Done — every new lead gets follow-ups automatically.

Full walkthrough with screenshots: www.nocoderequired.net/posts/automate-client-follow-ups-no-code/

Common mistakes: Don't automate before writing the emails. Don't skip the test run. Don't build a 7-step sequence on day one — ship the 3-email version first.

Path A: After it's running

WHAT TO DO ONCE IT WORKS

Option A — Add a 4th email at day 7. Share a case study, testimonial, or link to a relevant blog post. Value-add, no hard sell.

Option B — Log cold leads. Add a final Make step: if no reply after 7 days, create a Notion card with the lead's name, email, and what they asked about. Review once a week.

MAKE VS ZAPIER FOR THIS WORKFLOW

- **Make.com** — better free tier (1,000 ops), more control over multi-step delays. Use for Path A.
- **Zapier** — easier first experience, but 100 tasks/month caps out fast on sequences. Fine for Path B.

WHAT THIS COSTS

- Make.com free tier: **\$0/month** (1,000 operations — enough for dozens of leads)
- Form tool (Tally, Google Forms): **\$0**
- Your email (Gmail/Outlook): **\$0**
- Developer: **not required**

I built this in one afternoon. It landed 3 clients in the first month that I would have otherwise lost. The entire system costs \$0 on Make's free tier. You don't need to be technical — you need 90 minutes and 3 short emails.

Paths B & C — Quick setup

Build Path A first. Come back to these when you want more automation wins.

Path B: Social Media Backup ~15 min · Zapier

- 1 Sign up at zapier.com. Click **"Create Zap."**
- 2 **Trigger:** Instagram → New Post on Your Account.
- 3 **Action:** Google Sheets → Create Spreadsheet Row.
- 4 Map fields: Caption → A, Image URL → B, Date → C, Post URL → D.
- 5 Test with a recent post. Publish the Zap.

Why it matters: If your account gets suspended, you still have every caption, link, and date backed up — for free.

Path C: New Subscriber Alert ~10 min · Make.com

- 1 In Make, create a new scenario.
- 2 **Trigger:** Your email platform (Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Buttdown) → New Subscriber.
- 3 **Action:** Telegram / Slack / Discord → Send Message.
- 4 Message: *"New subscriber: [email] — welcome them!"*
- 5 Turn it on. You get a ping every time someone joins your list.

Why it matters: Growth feels abstract until you get a real-time notification. It's motivating — and free.

More automations on the blog: Build your first automation in 15 minutes · Webhooks explained · My automation pipeline — all at www.nocoderequired.net/posts/

What to do next

You have the tools. You have the workflow. Here's the path after your first win.

Today: Build Path A. One workflow. Not three.

This week: Use it daily. If it saves time, keep it. If not, delete and try Path B.

Start Here page: 5-step AI journey for complete beginners
www.nocoderequired.net/start-here/

AI Tool Advisor: Not sure which tool fits? 3 questions → 1 recommendation
www.nocoderequired.net/ai-tool-advisor.html

New posts every week: Real tools, tested workflows, no jargon
www.nocoderequired.net/posts/


www.nocoderequired.net

*Real tools. Tested workflows. No jargon.
Things you can actually use today.*

Reply to your welcome email if you get stuck — I read them.